



Student Number:

Teacher:

St George Girls High School

Mathematics Extension 1

2026 Trial HSC Examination

General Instructions

- Reading time – **10 minutes**
- Working time – **2 hours**
- Write using **black** pen
- Calculators approved by NESA may be used
- A reference sheet is provided
- For questions in **Section I**, use the multiple-choice answer sheet provided
- For questions in **Section II**:
 - answer the questions in the writing booklets provided
 - begin each question in a new booklet
 - extra writing booklets are available if needed
 - show relevant mathematical reasoning and/or calculations
 - marks may not be awarded for incomplete or poorly presented solutions, or where multiple solutions are provided
- Diagrams are not to scale

Total Marks: 70 **Section I – 10 marks** (pages 1–5)

- Attempt Questions 1–10
- Allow about 15 minutes for this section

Section II – 60 marks (pages 6–10)

- Attempt Questions 11–15
- Allow about 1 hour 45 minutes for this section

Q1 - 10	/10
Q11	/12
Q12	/12
Q13	/12
Q14	/12
Q15	/12
Total	/70
Percentage	%

Section I

10 marks

Attempt Questions 1–10

Allow about 15 minutes for this section

Use the multiple-choice answer sheet for Questions 1–10.

1. $2 \cos 3A \sin A =$

- (A) $\sin 4A - \sin 2A.$
- (B) $\sin 4A + \sin 2A.$
- (C) $\sin 2A - \sin 4A.$
- (D) $-\sin 4A - \sin 2A.$

2. Determine $\frac{d}{dx} \cos^{-1} \frac{x}{2}.$

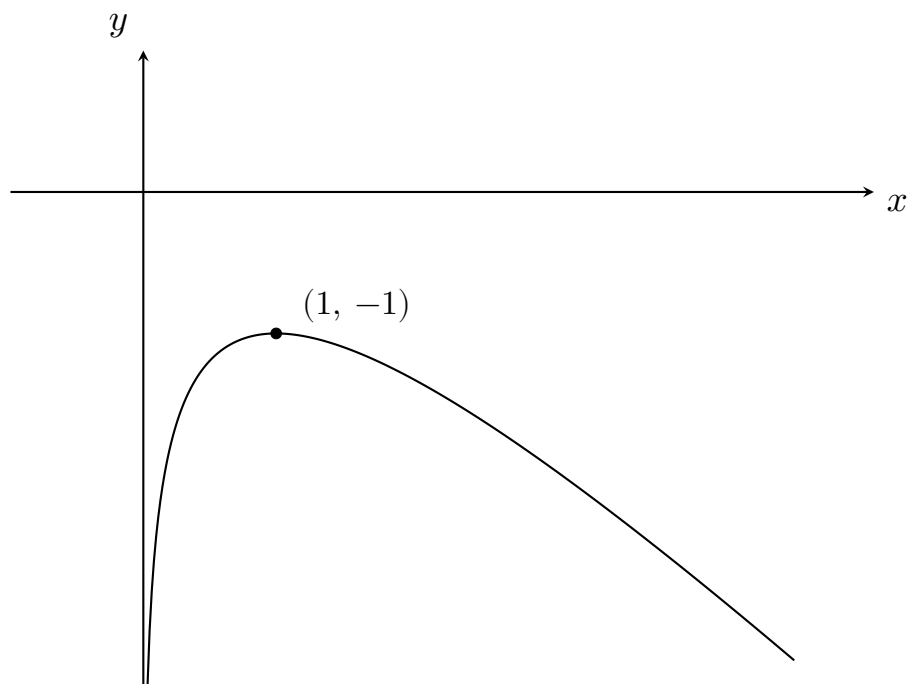
- (A) $\frac{1}{\sqrt{4-x^2}}$
- (B) $\frac{-1}{\sqrt{4-x^2}}$
- (C) $\frac{1}{2\sqrt{4-x^2}}$
- (D) $\frac{-1}{2\sqrt{4-x^2}}$

3. What is the magnitude of $\text{proj}_{\tilde{a}} \tilde{b}$ if $\tilde{a} = 3\tilde{i} - 2\tilde{j}$ and $\tilde{b} = \tilde{i} + 3\tilde{j}$?

- (A) $\frac{-3}{\sqrt{10}}$
- (B) $\frac{-3}{\sqrt{13}}$
- (C) $\frac{3}{\sqrt{13}}$
- (D) $\frac{3}{\sqrt{10}}$

4. State the number of solutions to $\cos \frac{x}{2} \sin \frac{x}{2} = 0$ for $0 \leq x \leq 2\pi$.
- (A) 0
(B) 1
(C) 2
(D) 3
5. In how many ways can six people be seated around a circular table if 2 particular people refuse to sit next to each other?
- (A) 72
(B) 120
(C) 480
(D) 720
6. Determine $\arcsin \left(\sin \frac{5\pi}{7} \right)$.
- (A) $-\frac{5\pi}{7}$
(B) $-\frac{2\pi}{7}$
(C) $\frac{2\pi}{7}$
(D) $\frac{5\pi}{7}$
7. $f(x)$ is a continuous function.
 $f(x) = 5$ has 3 distinct solutions. $|f(x)|$ will have
- (A) at least 3 solutions.
(B) at most 3 solutions.
(C) at most 6 solutions.
(D) at least 6 solutions.

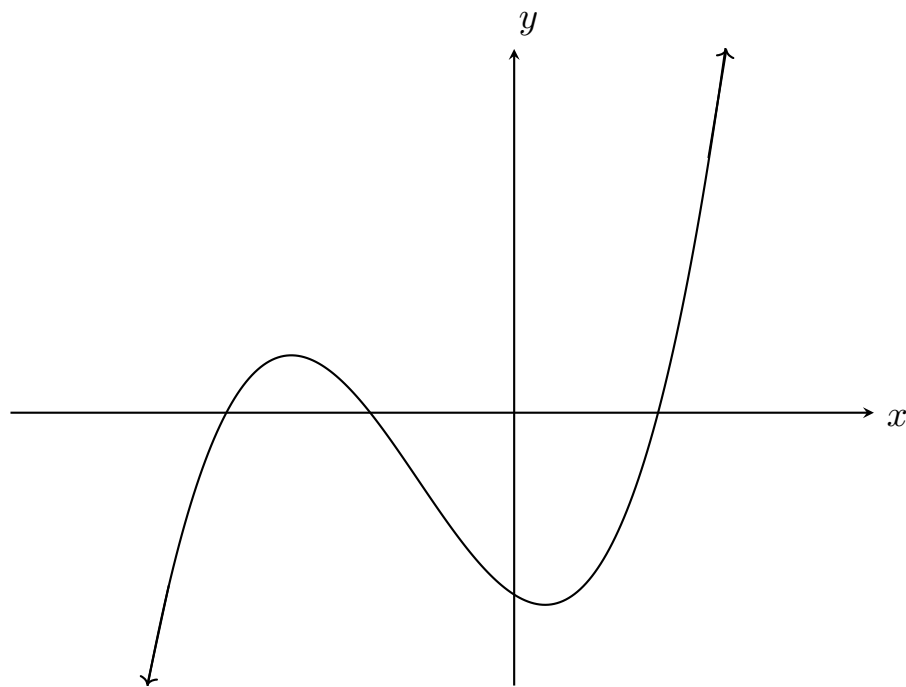
8. Below is the graph of $y = f(x) + g(x)$. It's natural domain is $x > 0$.
What are the possible expressions of $f(x)$ and $g(x)$?



- (A) $f(x) = -\ln x$ and $g(x) = x$
(B) $f(x) = -\frac{1}{x}$ and $g(x) = x$
(C) $f(x) = \frac{1}{x}$ and $g(x) = -x$
(D) $f(x) = \ln x$ and $g(x) = -x$

9. The graph of $y = x^3 + bx^2 - x + d$ is given below. Assume it is drawn to scale. Which of the following statements are true?

- I. $b < 0$
- II. $d < 0$
- III. $bd < 0$



- (A) I only.
 - (B) II only.
 - (C) I and III.
 - (D) II and III.
10. $y = f(x)$ is a curve that passes through $(1, 3)$ with a gradient of 2. By letting $g(x) = f^{-1}(x)$, determine $g'(3)$.

- (A) $-\frac{1}{2}$
- (B) $\frac{1}{2}$
- (C) 3
- (D) $\frac{1}{3}$

Section II

60 marks

Attempt Questions 11–15

Allow about 1 hour 45 minutes for this section

Answer each question in a SEPARATE writing booklet.

Your answers should include relevant mathematical reasoning and/or calculations.

Question 11 (12 marks) Start this in a NEW WRITING BOOKLET.

(a) Find $\int \cos^2 3x \, dx$. **2**

(b) Consider the two vectors $\mathbf{a} = \begin{pmatrix} -3 \\ m \end{pmatrix}$ and $\mathbf{b} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$. If $\mathbf{a}$ is parallel to $\mathbf{b}$, **1**
what is the value of m ?

(c) A drone is set to fly at a velocity of $\begin{pmatrix} 15 \\ 12 \end{pmatrix}$ km/h. **2**
However, there is wind blowing at $\begin{pmatrix} -6 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix}$ km/h.
Calculate the overall speed of the drone. Leave your answer to 1 decimal place.

(d) Solve $\frac{1}{x-5} \leq 3$. **3**

(e) Determine the coefficient of x^2 in $\left(1 + \frac{1}{x}\right)(x+1)^3$. **2**

(f) $P(x) = (a^2 - 1)x^3 + ax^2 + -7x + 2$ is divisible by $(x - 1)$. **2**
Determine the possible values of a .

Question 12 (12 marks) Start this in a NEW WRITING BOOKLET.

- (a) Prove by mathematical induction that for all integers $n \geq 1$: **3**

$$\frac{1}{1 \cdot 2} + \frac{1}{2 \cdot 3} + \frac{1}{3 \cdot 4} + \cdots + \frac{1}{n(n+1)} = \frac{n}{n+1}$$

- (b) The position vector of a particle at time t seconds is given below. **2**

$$\underset{\sim}{r}(t) = (3 - t)\underset{\sim}{i} - 2\sqrt{t}\underset{\sim}{j}$$

Determine the velocity vector at $t = 4$.

- (c) Graph the curve represented by the pair of parametric equations below **2**
for $-1 \leq t \leq 1$.

$$\begin{aligned}x &= 1 + t \\y &= -t^2\end{aligned}$$

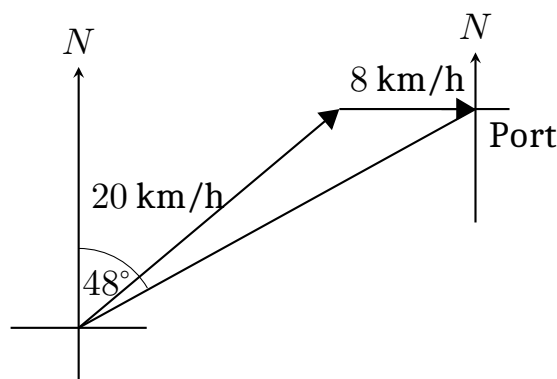
- (d) (i) Express $3 \cos x + \sqrt{3} \sin x$ in the form $R \cos(x + \alpha)$ for $-\frac{\pi}{2} \leq \alpha \leq 0$. **3**

- (ii) Hence, solve $3 \cos x + \sqrt{3} \sin x = 3$ for $0 \leq x \leq 2\pi$. **2**

Question 13 (12 marks) Start this in a NEW WRITING BOOKLET.

(a) By using the substitution $u = 1 - x^2$, find $\int -2x^3\sqrt{1 - x^2} dx$. **3**

- (b) A boat needs to travel to a port that is on a bearing of 048° . **3**
 The boat's engine is set to drive at a constant speed of 20 km/h.
 There is a current flowing from the West at a constant speed of 8 km/h.



On what bearing, to the nearest degree, should the boat be directed in order to reach the port?

- (c) From a height of 1.75 m, a ball was thrown directly upwards at a speed of 25 m/s.

Assume a gravitational acceleration of -10 m/s^2 and no air resistance.

- (i) Find an equation to represent the height of the ball from the ground, h , in terms of t seconds after the ball is thrown. **2**

- (ii) Hence, when will the ball hit the ground? Answer to the nearest second. **1**

- (d) A triangle has two fixed side lengths of length 8 cm and 6 cm. The included angle, θ , is increasing at a constant rate of $\frac{\pi}{6}$ radians per second. **3**

Find the exact rate the area of the triangle is increasing when $\theta = \frac{\pi}{3}$.

Question 14 (12 marks) Start this in a NEW WRITING BOOKLET.

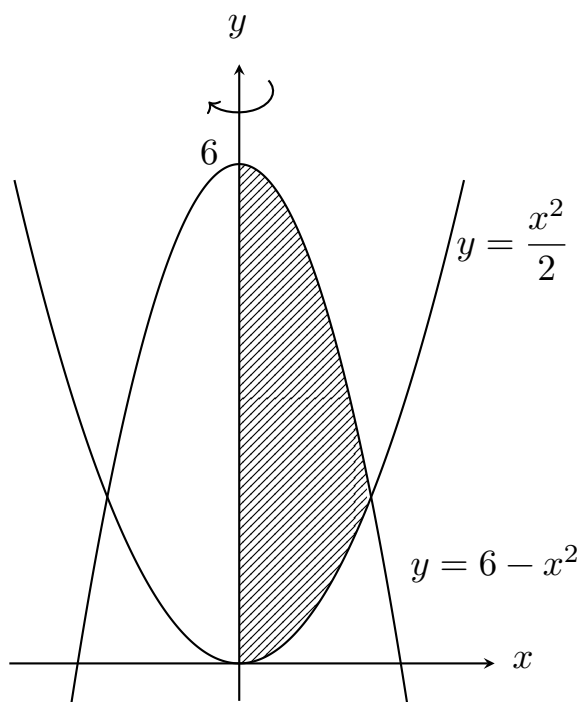
- (a) Solve for x , given

2

$$\sin^{-1} x - \cos^{-1} x = \frac{\pi}{6}.$$

- (b) The region bounded by $y = \frac{x^2}{2}$, $y = 6 - x^2$, and $x = 0$ is rotated about the y -axis.

4



Determine the exact volume formed.

- (c) It is known that the product of two consecutive numbers is even.
 I.e. $k(k + 1) = 2A$, where k and A are integers.

3

Prove by mathematical induction that for all integers $n \geq 1$,

$$n^3 + 11n \text{ is divisible by } 6.$$

- (d) (i) Show that $\binom{n+1}{r+1} = \binom{n}{r} + \binom{n}{r+1}$.

2

- (ii) Hence, find ONE possible set of values for p and q such that

1

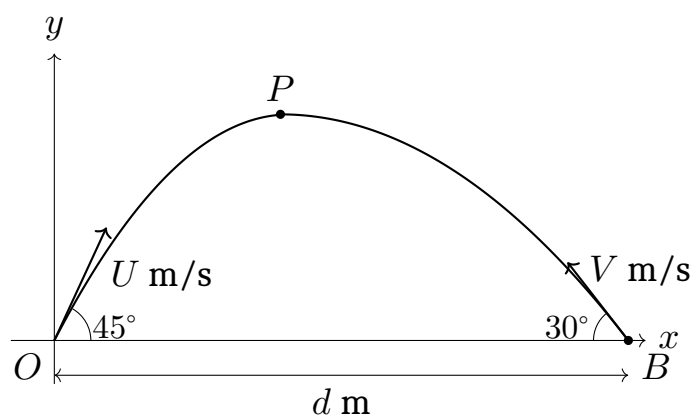
$$\binom{2025}{41} + \binom{2025}{42} + \binom{2026}{43} = \binom{p}{q}.$$

Question 15 (12 marks) Start this in a NEW WRITING BOOKLET.

- (a) Two projectiles are fired at the same time to collide at a point P , when they are both at their **maximum height**.

Projectile A is fired from the origin at a speed of U m/s at an angle of 45° from the horizontal.

Projectile B is fired from point B, d metres from O at a speed of V m/s at an angle of 30° from the horizontal, as shown in the diagram below.



The displacement vector equations from O are as follows.

You do NOT need to derive these.

$$\underline{r}_A(t) = \left(\frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} t \right) \underline{i} + \left(\frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} t - 5t^2 \right) \underline{j}$$

$$\underline{r}_B(t) = \left(d - \frac{V\sqrt{3}}{2} t \right) \underline{i} + \left(\frac{V}{2} t - 5t^2 \right) \underline{j}$$

- (i) Show that the projectile from O reaches its maximum height after

1

$$t = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{20}.$$

- (ii) Show that at point P ,

1

$$V = U\sqrt{2}.$$

- (iii) Hence, determine the distance d between O and B in terms of U .

2

Question 15 continues on the next page

Question 15 continued

- (b) An object has three forces acting on it. The forces are:

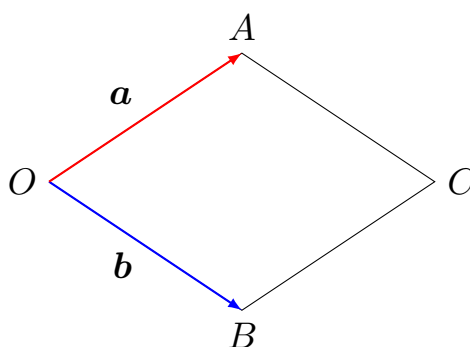
4

$$\mathbf{F}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} -a^2 + 3a \\ a^3 - 6a \end{pmatrix} \quad \mathbf{F}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} k + 4 \\ -10a + k \end{pmatrix} \quad \mathbf{F}_3 = \begin{pmatrix} -3a - 2k \\ -24 \end{pmatrix}$$

If the object is in equilibrium, what are the possible values of a ?

- (c) The figure $OACB$ below is a rhombus of area 4 square units.

$\overrightarrow{OA}$ is defined as $\mathbf{a}$ and $\overrightarrow{OB}$ is defined as $\mathbf{b}$.



The information below are given. Do NOT prove them.

- the area of a rhombus is $A = \frac{1}{2}xy$, where x and y are the diagonal lengths
- $(\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}) \cdot (\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}) = |\mathbf{u}|^2 + |\mathbf{v}|^2 + 2\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{v}$

- (i) Show that

2

$$|\mathbf{a} + \mathbf{b}|^2 |\mathbf{b} - \mathbf{a}|^2 = 64.$$

- (ii) Hence, show that:

2

$$|\mathbf{a}|^4 - (\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{b})^2 = 16$$

End of paper

MARKER'S COMMENTS

$$1. 2\cos 3A \sin A = 2 \cdot \frac{1}{2} [\sin(3A+A) - \sin(3A-A)]$$

$$= \sin 4A - \sin 2A$$

[A]

$$2. \frac{d}{dx} \cos^{-1}\left(\frac{x}{2}\right) = \frac{1}{2} \cdot \frac{-1}{\sqrt{1 - \left(\frac{x}{2}\right)^2}}$$

$$= \frac{-1}{\sqrt{4 - x^2}}$$

[B]

$$3. \text{proj}_{\vec{a}} \vec{b} = \frac{\vec{a} \cdot \vec{b}}{|\vec{a}|^2} \vec{a}$$

$$= \frac{3-6}{3^2+2^2} \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$= -\frac{3}{13} \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -2 \end{pmatrix}$$

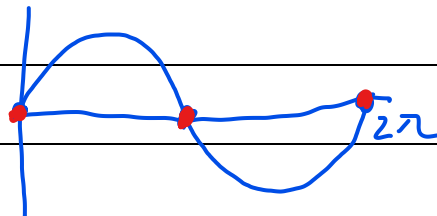
$$\therefore |\text{proj}_{\vec{a}} \vec{b}| = \frac{3}{13} \sqrt{3^2+2^2}$$

$$= \frac{3}{\sqrt{13}}$$

[C]

$$4. \cos \frac{x}{2} \sin \frac{x}{2} = 0$$

$$\frac{1}{2} \sin x = 0$$



$\therefore$ 3 solutions

[D]

MARKER'S COMMENTS

[illegible]

MARKER'S COMMENTS

[illegible]

Q11 a) $\int \cos^2 3x \, dx$

$$= \int \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2} \cos 6x \, dx$$

$$= \frac{1}{2} \int 1 + \cos 6x \, dx$$

$$= \frac{1}{2} \left(x + \frac{\sin 6x}{6} \right) + c$$

or $\frac{1}{2} x + \frac{\sin 6x}{6} + c$

1 mark for rewriting the integrand correctly

1 mark for integrating correctly

(2)

Overall, this question was well answered.

b) $\underline{a} = \begin{pmatrix} -3 \\ m \end{pmatrix}$ $\underline{b} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$

Now $\underline{a} = k \underline{b}$ since $\underline{a}$ is parallel to $\underline{b}$

$$\begin{pmatrix} -3 \\ m \end{pmatrix} = k \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\therefore k = -3$$

$$\therefore m = k \times 4$$

$$m = -3 \times 4$$

$$m = -12$$

1 mark

Overall, this question was well answered.

(1)

c) Let $\underline{w}$ be the velocity wind vector

and $\underline{u}$ be the velocity vector of the drone

$$\underline{w} = \begin{pmatrix} -6 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix} \quad \& \quad \underline{u} = \begin{pmatrix} 15 \\ 12 \end{pmatrix}$$

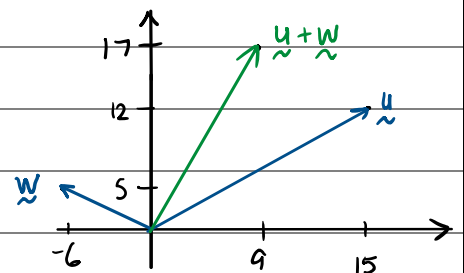
Resulting vector

$$= \underline{u} + \underline{w}$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} 15 \\ 12 \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} -6 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$= \begin{pmatrix} 9 \\ 17 \end{pmatrix}$$

1 mark for resulting vector



$$\text{speed} = |\underline{u} + \underline{w}| = \sqrt{9^2 + 17^2}$$

$$\approx 19.2 \text{ km/h}$$

1 mark for correct speed

(2)

2 marks - Complete and correct solution

$1\frac{1}{2}$ marks - If vectors were added incorrectly and speed was correctly calculated. Eg $\begin{pmatrix} 15 \\ 12 \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} -6 \\ 5 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 9 \\ 7 \end{pmatrix} \therefore \text{speed} = \sqrt{9^2 + 7^2}$

1 mark - If vectors were subtracted and speed was calculated as $\sqrt{490}$

- For resulting vector $\begin{pmatrix} 9 \\ 17 \end{pmatrix}$

Overall, not well answered

d) **Method 1** Multiplying both sides by the square of the denominator

$$\frac{1}{x-5} \leq 3$$

$$(x-5)^2 \times \frac{1}{x-5} \leq 3 \times (x-5)^2, \quad x \neq 5$$

$$\frac{x-5}{x-5} \leq 3(x-5)^2 \quad \text{—— 1 mark}$$

$$3(x-5)^2 - (x-5) \geq 0$$

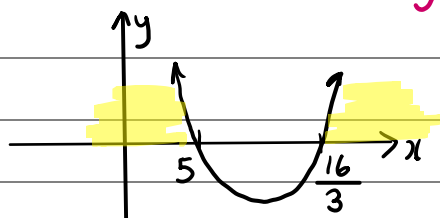
$$(x-5)(3(x-5) - 1) \geq 0$$

$$(x-5)(3x - 15 - 1) \geq 0$$

$$(x-5)(3x - 16) \geq 0$$

$$\text{or } 3x^2 - 31x + 80 \geq 0$$

} —— 1 mark for either inequality



$\therefore x < 5, \quad x \geq 5\frac{1}{3}$ —— 1 mark for correct solution (3)

- 85% of the students used this method and for many it was not well answered.

Many minor errors were made throughout students' solution. Some of the errors were:

- Wrong inequality sign was applied after step 1
- the values on the x-axis were in the wrong order
- the concavity of the parabola was drawn incorrectly
- $x = 5$ was included in the solutions. ($\frac{1}{2}$ mark off)

- 3 marks for correct solution, $x < 5$ or $x \geq \frac{16}{3}$

- $2\frac{1}{2}$ marks - for solution $x \leq 5$ or $x \geq \frac{16}{3}$

or - for solution $x \leq \frac{16}{3}, \quad x > 5$ if drew $\rightarrow$

- 2 marks - for solution $5 < x \leq \frac{16}{3}$ because of incorrect inequality sign or drawing the parabola incorrectly

— for obtaining the inequality $3x^2 - 31x + 80 \geq 0$

- 1 mark - for multiplying both sides by the square of the denominator correctly.

For those students who use this method, please **REVIEW**

Method 2 - Critical point method

$$\frac{1}{x-5} \leq 3$$

• Discontinuous at $x=5$.

• For equality $\frac{1}{x-5} = 3$

$$1 = 3(x-5)$$

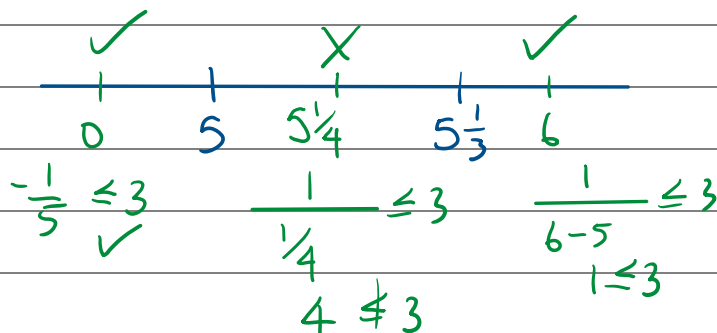
$$1 = 3x - 15$$

$$3x = 16$$

$$x = \frac{16}{3} = 5\frac{1}{3}$$

$\therefore$ The critical points are 5 and $5\frac{1}{3}$

2



$\therefore x < 5$ or $x \geq 5\frac{1}{3}$

1

(3)

This was well done for the handful of students who used this method.

e) $(1 + \frac{1}{x})(x+1)^3$
 $= (1 + \frac{1}{x})(x^3 + 3x^2 + 3x + 1)$ — 1 mark for expanding $(1+x)^3$

For term in x^2 :

correctly

$$1 \times 3x^2 + \frac{1}{x} \times x^3$$

$$= 3x^2 + x^2$$

$$= 4x^2$$

$\therefore$ coefficient of x^2 is 4. — 1 mark for correct answer

(2)

Mostly well attempted. Some minor errors with addition.

Method 2:

A handful of students used the general term to answer this question. A few minor errors were made. Take care if using. Please see solution below

$$(1 + \frac{1}{x})(1+x)^3 = (1+x^{-1})^3 C_r 1^{3-r} x^r$$

$$= (1+x^{-1})^3 C_r x^r$$

$$= {}^3C_r x^r + {}^3C_r x^r \times x^{-1}$$

$$= {}^3C_r x^r + {}^3C_r x^{r-1}$$

For x^2 : $r=2$ & $r-1=2$

$$\therefore (1 + \frac{1}{x})(1+x)^3 = {}^3C_2 x^2 + {}^3C_3 x^2$$

$$= 3x^2 + x^2$$

$$= 4x^2$$

$\therefore$ coefficient is 4

— 1

(2)

OR $(1 + \frac{1}{x})(1+x)^3 = (1+x^{-1})({}^3C_r x^{3-r} \cdot 1^r)$

$$= {}^3C_r x^{3-r} + {}^3C_r x^{3-r-1}$$

For x^2 : $r=1$, $3-r=2$

$r=0$, $3-r-1=2$

$$\therefore = {}^3C_1 x^2 + {}^3C_0 x^2$$

$$= 3x^2 + x^2$$

$$= 4x^2$$

$$f) P(x) = (a^2 - 1)x^3 + ax^2 - 7x + 2$$

If divisible by $x - 1$ then

$$P(1) = 0$$

$$\left. \begin{aligned} a^2 - 1 + a - 7 + 2 &= 0 \\ a^2 + a - 6 &= 0 \end{aligned} \right\} \text{ ————— 1 mark}$$

$$(a + 3)(a - 2) = 0$$

$$\therefore a = -3 \text{ or } 2 \quad \text{————— 1 mark}$$

②

Overall, this part was very well done.
However there were a handful of students who need to review factorising a quadratic equation.

Question 12

2026 Trials

a) Prove by mathematical induction that for all integers that for all integers $n \geq 1$:

$$\frac{1}{1 \cdot 2} + \frac{1}{2 \cdot 3} + \frac{1}{3 \cdot 4} + \dots + \frac{1}{n(n+1)} = \frac{n}{n+1}$$

Step 1 Prove the statement is true for $n=1$

$$\text{LHS} = \frac{1}{n(n+1)}$$

$$\text{RHS} = \frac{n}{n+1}$$

$$= \frac{1}{1(1+1)}$$

$$= \frac{1}{1+1}$$

$$= \frac{1}{2}$$

$$= \frac{1}{2}$$

- link

$$\therefore \text{LHS} = \text{RHS}$$

$\therefore$ Prove that the statement is true for $n=1$.

Step 2

Assume the statement is true for $n=k$

$$\text{That is: } \frac{1}{1 \cdot 2} + \frac{1}{2 \cdot 3} + \frac{1}{3 \cdot 4} + \dots + \frac{1}{k(k+1)} = \frac{k}{k+1}$$

!"#\$%&'()*! !%*+&'

step 3 Prove the statement is true for $n = k+1$

$$\text{RTP: } \frac{1}{1 \cdot 2} + \frac{1}{2 \cdot 3} + \frac{1}{3 \cdot 4} + \dots + \frac{1}{k(k+1)} + \frac{1}{(k+1)(k+1+1)} = \frac{k+1}{k+1+1}$$

That is:

$$\frac{1}{1 \cdot 2} + \frac{1}{2 \cdot 3} + \frac{1}{3 \cdot 4} + \dots + \frac{1}{k(k+1)} + \frac{1}{(k+1)(k+2)} = \frac{k+1}{k+2}$$

$$\text{LHS} = \frac{1}{1 \cdot 2} + \frac{1}{2 \cdot 3} + \frac{1}{3 \cdot 4} + \dots + \frac{1}{k(k+1)} + \frac{1}{(k+1)(k+2)}$$

from step 2 (inductive hypothesis)

$$= \frac{k}{k+1} + \frac{1}{(k+1)(k+2)} \quad \text{link - For using the inductive hypothesis}$$

$$= \frac{k(k+2) + 1}{(k+1)(k+2)}$$

$$= \frac{k^2 + 2k + 1}{(k+1)(k+2)}$$

$$= \frac{\cancel{(k+1)}^1 (k+1)}{\cancel{(k+1)}_1 (k+2)}$$

link for appropriate algebraic manipulation

$$= \frac{k+1}{k+2}$$

$$= \text{RHS}$$

$\therefore$ LHS = RHS Conclusion Therefore true for $n = k+1$

when it is true for $n = k$. Since it is true for $n = 1$ then it is also true for $n = 1+1 = 2$, $n = 2+1 = 3$, and so on.

Therefore, it is true for all integers n by the principle of mathematical induction.

!"#\$%&'()*! !%*+&'

Teacher's Comment

Generally, well done.

Some students did not show 'how the inductive step' was used in the proof for $n = k+1$

$$\frac{1}{1 \cdot 2} + \frac{1}{2 \cdot 3} + \frac{1}{3 \cdot 4} + \dots + \frac{1}{k(k+1)} + \frac{1}{(k+1)(k+2)}$$

from step 2 (inductive hypothesis)

! "\$%#&'() ! ! %*+&'

b) The position vector of a particle at time t seconds is given below.

$$\mathbf{r}(t) = (3-t)\mathbf{i} - 2\sqrt{t}\mathbf{j}$$

Determine the velocity vector at $t=4$.

$$\mathbf{v}(t) = \frac{d}{dt} (3-t)\mathbf{i} - \frac{d}{dt} 2\sqrt{t}\mathbf{j}$$

$$= \frac{d}{dt} (3-t)\mathbf{i} - \frac{d}{dt} 2t^{1/2}\mathbf{j}$$

$$= -\mathbf{i} - 2 \times \frac{1}{2} t^{-1/2}\mathbf{j}$$

$$= -\mathbf{i} - t^{-1/2}\mathbf{j}$$

$$\text{or } = -\mathbf{i} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{t}}\mathbf{j}$$

— look — No $\frac{1}{2}$ mark was awarded.

$$\mathbf{v}(4) = -\mathbf{i} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{4}}\mathbf{j}$$

$$= -\mathbf{i} - \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{j} \quad \text{— look — No } \frac{1}{2}$$

If magnitude of the velocity vector mark was awarded was found then $\frac{1}{2}$ a mark was deducted.

Teacher's Comments

CFPE was awarded to students who had attempted to find the velocity vector either via differentiation or integration? Quite well done, however, a few students integrated rather than differentiating the given expression for the position vector. A few students attempted to find the magnitude of the velocity vector when the question is clearly asking students to determine the velocity vector.

! "\$%#&'()!!%*+&'

12c) Graph the curve represented by the pair of parametric equations below for $-1 \leq t \leq 1$

$$x = 1 + t$$

$$y = -t^2$$

$$x = 1 + t$$

$$t = x - 1$$

$$y = -t^2$$

$$= -(x-1)^2$$

— 1mk (Not required to show → not part of the question)

At $t = -1$

$$x = 1 + t$$

$$= 1 + (-1)$$

$$= 0$$

$$y = -t^2$$

$$= -(-1)^2$$

$$= -1$$

$$\therefore (0, -1)$$

At $t = 1$

$$x = 1 + t$$

$$= 1 + 1$$

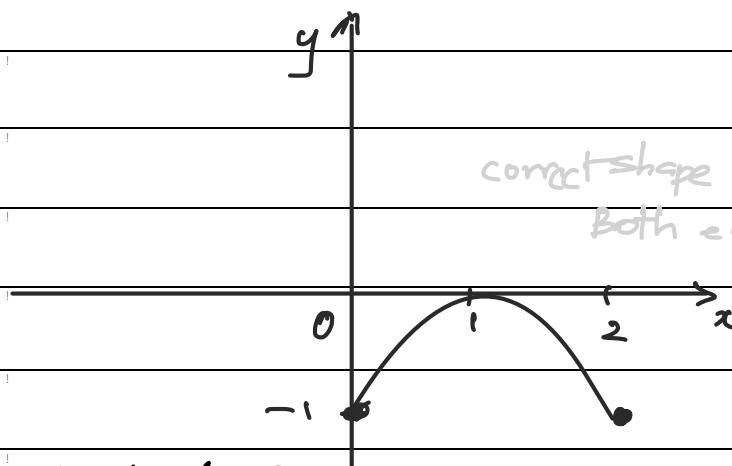
$$= 2$$

$$y = -t^2$$

$$= -(1)^2$$

$$= -1$$

$$\therefore (2, -1)$$



correct shape - 1/2 mk

Both end-points correct - 1/2 mk

If a student just sketches the graph then award 1mk for the correct shape and 1/2 mark each for the correct end-points.

Teacher's Comments

Generally, well attempted. However, the majority of students forgot to consider the given domain.

! "#\$%#&'()!!%*+&'

d) Express $3 \cos x + \sqrt{3} \sin x$ in the form

$$R \cos(x + \alpha) \text{ for } -\frac{\pi}{2} \leq \alpha \leq 2\pi.$$

$$3 \cos x + \sqrt{3} \sin x = R \cos(x + \alpha)$$

$$= R [\cos x \cos \alpha - \sin x \sin \alpha]$$

$$= R \cos x \cos \alpha - R \sin x \sin \alpha$$

If we compare the coefficients of $\cos x$ and $\sin x$ on both sides of the equation, we obtain:

$$R \cos \alpha = 3 \quad \dots \text{---} \textcircled{1}$$

$$-R \sin \alpha = \sqrt{3} \quad \dots \text{---} \textcircled{2}$$

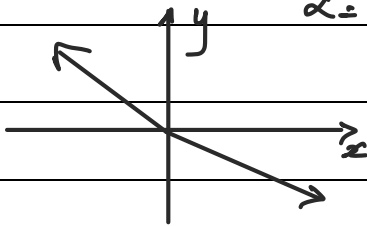
$$\textcircled{2} \div \textcircled{1}$$

$$-\tan \alpha = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{3} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$$

$$\therefore \tan \alpha = -\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$$

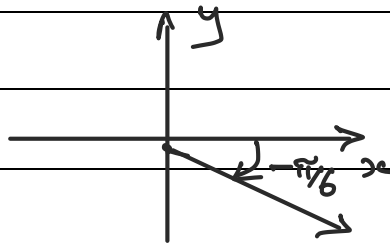
$$\alpha = \tan^{-1}\left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}\right) = \frac{\pi}{6} \text{ (Related angle)}$$

$\therefore$ overlap is quadrant 4



$$\text{But } -\frac{\pi}{2} \leq \alpha \leq 0$$

$\therefore \alpha$ lies in the 4th quadrant



Recognising $\alpha = \pi/6$ is the related angle $\rightarrow \frac{1}{2}\pi$

Recognising $\alpha = \frac{11\pi}{6} \rightarrow \frac{1}{2}\pi$

Recognising that $\alpha = -\pi/6$ $\rightarrow \frac{1}{2}\pi$ (As the student recognises the quadrant in which the angle lies)
well as the quadrant in which α lies).

(As the student recognises the quadrant in which the angle lies)

!"#\$%&'()*! !%*+&'

Squaring and adding the 2 equations above gives:

$$R^2 \cos^2 \alpha = 9$$

$$R^2 \sin^2 \alpha = 3$$

$$\therefore R^2 \cos^2 \alpha + R^2 \sin^2 \alpha = 12$$

$$\therefore R^2 (\sin^2 \alpha + \cos^2 \alpha) = 12$$

$$R = \pm \sqrt{12} \text{ But } R > 0 \text{ by convention} \\ = 2\sqrt{3} \quad \text{--- 1mk}$$

Writing this in the required form gives us:

$$\therefore 3 \cos x + \sqrt{3} \sin x = 2\sqrt{3} \cos \left(x - \pi/6 \right) \\ \text{--- 1/2mk}$$

Teacher's Comments

Poorly attempted. Common error was not recognising that $\alpha = -\pi/6$. Some students were 'tricked' by the fact that they had to leave their answer in the form $R \cos(x + \alpha)$

! "\$%#&'() ! ! %*+&'

CFPE from part (i)

ii) Hence, solve $3 \cos x + \sqrt{3} = 3$ for $0 \leq x \leq 2\pi$.

$$2\sqrt{3} \cos\left(x - \frac{\pi}{6}\right) = 3$$

$$\begin{aligned} \cos\left(x - \frac{\pi}{6}\right) &= 3 \div 2\sqrt{3} \\ &= 3 \times \frac{1}{2\sqrt{3}} \end{aligned}$$

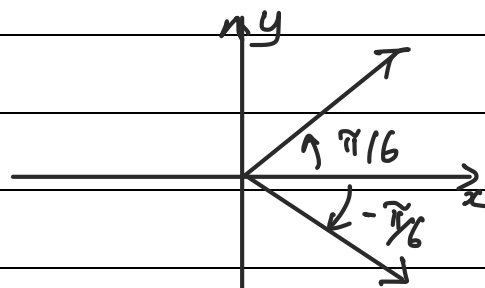
$$= \frac{3}{2\sqrt{3}} \times \frac{\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{3}}$$

$$= \frac{3\sqrt{3}}{6}$$

$$= \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$$

$$\therefore \cos\left(x - \frac{\pi}{6}\right) = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$$

$$\cos^{-1}\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right) = \frac{\pi}{6} \quad (\text{Related angle})$$



$$0 \leq x \leq 2\pi$$

$$-\frac{\pi}{6} \leq x - \frac{\pi}{6} \leq \frac{11\pi}{6}$$

If students

had simplified $\therefore$

their question

then they were

penalised for

doing so.

$$x - \frac{\pi}{6} = -\frac{\pi}{6}, \frac{\pi}{6}, \frac{11\pi}{6}$$

$$\therefore x = -\frac{\pi}{6} + \frac{\pi}{6}, \frac{\pi}{6} + \frac{\pi}{6}, \frac{11\pi}{6} + \frac{\pi}{6}$$

$$= 0, \frac{\pi}{3}, 2\pi$$

1/2 mark for ALL the correct final answers

Teacher's Comments

Poorly attempted. Students need

to re-visit the concepts of considering the domain and the appropriate quadrants.

MARKER'S COMMENTS

[illegible]

MARKER'S COMMENTS

[illegible]

QUESTION 14

! "\$%# '&' () ! ! % * + & '

METHOD 1

$$\sin^{-1}x - \cos^{-1}x = \frac{\pi}{6}$$

$$\sin^{-1}x + \cos^{-1}x = \frac{\pi}{2} \quad (+ \text{ identity})$$

$$2\sin^{-1}x = \frac{\pi}{6} + \frac{\pi}{2}$$

$$2\sin^{-1}x = \frac{4\pi}{6}$$

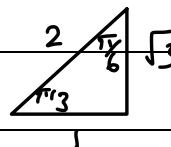
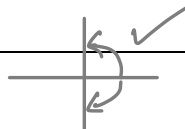
$$\sin^{-1}x = \frac{\pi}{3}$$

$$x = \sin \frac{\pi}{3}$$

$$x = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$$

① mark uses identity and either substitutes

or adds.



① Correctly finds x.

METHOD 2

$$\sin^{-1}x + \cos^{-1}x = \frac{\pi}{2}$$

$$\therefore \cos^{-1}x = \frac{\pi}{2} - \sin^{-1}x$$

$$\sin^{-1}x - \cos^{-1}x = \frac{\pi}{6}$$

$$\sin^{-1}x - \left(\frac{\pi}{2} - \sin^{-1}x \right) = \frac{\pi}{6}$$

$$\sin^{-1}x - \frac{\pi}{2} + \sin^{-1}x = \frac{\pi}{6}$$

$$2\sin^{-1}x = \frac{\pi}{6} + \frac{\pi}{2}$$

$$2\sin^{-1}x = \frac{4\pi}{6}$$

$$\sin^{-1}x = \frac{\pi}{3}$$

$$x = \sin \frac{\pi}{3}$$

$$x = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$$

Q14 continued

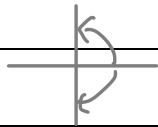
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METHOD 2

a) $\sin^{-1} x - \cos^{-1} x = \frac{\pi}{6}$

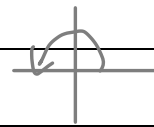
let $\alpha = \sin^{-1} x$

$\therefore \sin \alpha = \frac{x}{1}$

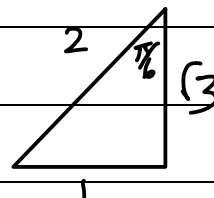
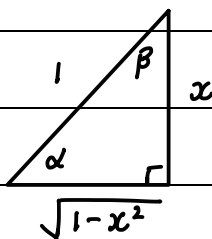


let $\beta = \cos^{-1} x$

$\cos \beta = \frac{x}{1}$



Overlap quad 1 $\therefore x > 0$



$\therefore \alpha - \beta = \frac{\pi}{6}$

$\sin(\alpha - \beta) = \sin \frac{\pi}{6}$

$\sin \alpha \cos \beta - \cos \alpha \sin \beta = \frac{1}{2}$

$x \times x - \sqrt{1-x^2} \times \sqrt{1-x^2} = \frac{1}{2}$

$x^2 - (1-x^2) = \frac{1}{2}$

$x^2 - 1 + x^2 = \frac{1}{2}$

$2x^2 = \frac{3}{2}$

$x^2 = \frac{3}{4}$

$x = \pm \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$

$x > 0$

$x = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$

(1/2) Apply strategy of taking sin of both sides

(1/2) Executing sin expansion correctly

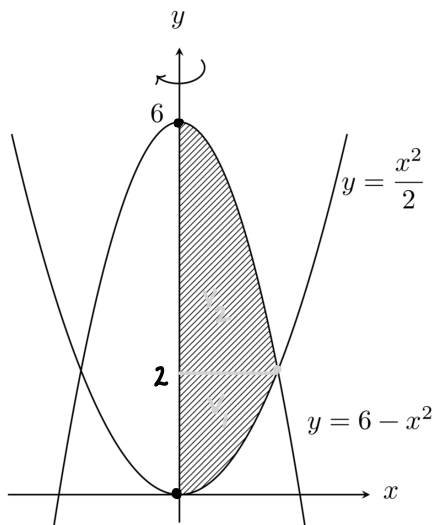
(1) Using the triangles to correctly find x

(1/2 mark for justifying $x > 0$)

NOTE: Review of inverse trig functions is advised. Many students had difficulty. For a 2 mark question, working out to obtain answer is required.

Q14 continued...

b)



$$y = \frac{x^2}{2}$$

$$x^2 = 2y$$

$\left(\frac{1}{2}\right)$ finds an expression for x^2 for either function.

$$y = 6 - x^2$$

$$x^2 = 6 - y$$

Intersection of $y = \frac{x^2}{2}$ and $y = 6 - x^2$

$$\frac{x^2}{2} = 6 - x^2$$

$$x^2 = 12 - 2x^2$$

$$3x^2 = 12$$

$$x^2 = 4$$

$$x = \pm 2$$

when $x = 2$, $y = \frac{2^2}{2}$
 $= 2$

① mark to find the point of intersection

$$\therefore V = \pi \int_0^2 2y \, dy + \pi \int_2^6 (6 - y) \, dy$$

① mark for correct process (addition of

$$= \pi \left[y^2 \right]_0^2 + \pi \left[6y - \frac{y^2}{2} \right]_2^6$$

$$= \pi \left[2^2 - 0^2 \right] + \pi \left[6(6) - \frac{6^2}{2} - \left(6(2) - \frac{2^2}{2} \right) \right]$$

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$$= 4\pi + \pi (36 - 18 - 10)$$

① Correctly evaluates

$$= 4\pi + 8\pi$$

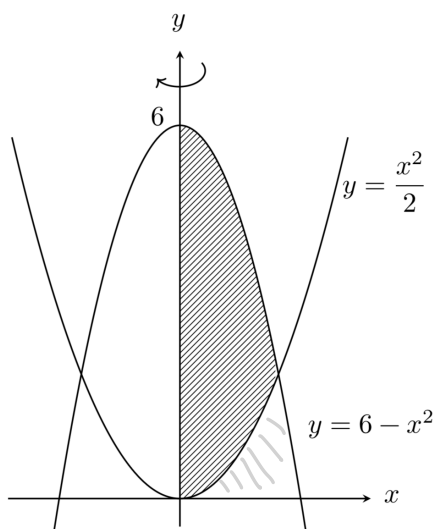
Volume.

$$= 12\pi \text{ u}^3$$

No CFPE as many of the ways to find the volume were completely incorrect and made much easier.

NOTE: 1 mark out of 4 awarded in total if the process was incorrect, however, demonstrated understanding of Volume formula.

METHOD 2



2 marks out of 4 awarded if student found point of intersection AND demonstrated correct use of Volume formula.

$$V = \pi \int_0^6 (6-y) dy - \left[\pi \int_0^2 (6-y) dy - \pi \int_0^2 2y dy \right]$$

Some marking

$$= 18\pi - \pi \left[6y - \frac{y^2}{2} - y^2 \right]_0^2$$

Scheme.

$$= 18\pi - \pi [12 - 2 - 4 - 0]$$

$$= 18\pi - 6\pi$$

$$= 12\pi$$

NOTE: This question was very poorly done. Many just found the volume from 6 to zero. Students did not find the point of intersection the split the volume as part was with one curve and part was with another. When students did split, they had the wrong bounds. Please review

Q14 continued...

!"#\$%#&'()!!%*+&'

c) Step 1 - Base Case - Prove true for $n=1$

$$n^3 + 11n$$

$$n=1 = (1)^3 + 11(1)$$

$$= 1 + 11$$

$$= 12$$

$$= 6(2) \text{ which is divisible by } 6$$

$\therefore$ True for $n=1$

① Correctly proves true for $n=1$

Step 2 - Inductive Hypothesis - Assume true for $n=k$

$$k^3 + 11k = 6M \text{ where } M \in \mathbb{Z}$$

② Correct assumption (must have a mention of

Step 3 - Inductive Step - Prove true for $n=k+1$

i.e. Prove $(k+1)^3 + 11(k+1)$ is divisible by 6.

$M \in \mathbb{Z}$ in both Step 2 and 3 if two pronumerals introduced AND correct statement of what is being proved.

$$(k+1)^3 + 11(k+1)$$

$$= k^3 + 3k^2 + 3k + 1 + 11k + 11$$

$$= k^3 + 11k + 3k^2 + 3k + 12$$

② Use of assumption anywhere in proof.

$$= 6M + 12 + 3k(k+1)$$

Note $k(k+1) = 2A$ $A, k \in \mathbb{Z}$ (given)

$$= 6M + 12 + 3 \times 2A$$

$$= 6M + 12 + 6A$$

① Correct use of given

$$= 6(M+2+A) \quad M, A \in \mathbb{Z}$$

information and correctly proved result.

which is divisible by 6

$\therefore$ True for $n=k+1$ when true for $n=k$. (1/2 mark deducted

$\therefore$ By the principle of mathematical induction, true or incorrect highlighted statement)

NOTE: This was well attempted. Some setting out issues, must define $6M$ for $M \in \mathbb{Z}$ and you need to state what you are proving. Many successfully proved result.

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Q14 continued ...

d) (i)

$$RHS = \binom{n}{r} + \binom{n}{r+1}$$

$$RHS = {}^nC_r + {}^nC_{r+1}$$

$$= \frac{n!}{r!(n-r)!} + \frac{n!}{(r+1)!(n-r-1)!}$$

$$= \frac{n!(r+1)}{(r+1)r!(n-r)!} + \frac{n!(n-r)}{(r+1)!(n-r)(n-r-1)!}$$

$$= \frac{n!(r+1+n-r)}{(r+1)!(n-r)!}$$

$$= \frac{n!(n+1)}{(r+1)!(n-r)!}$$

$$= \frac{(n+1)!}{(r+1)!(n-r)!}$$

$$= \frac{(n+1)!}{(r+1)![n+1-(r+1)]!}$$

$$= {}^{n+1}C_{r+1}$$

$$= LHS$$

$$LHS = \binom{n+1}{r+1}$$

$$LHS = {}^{n+1}C_{r+1}$$

$$= \frac{(n+1)!}{(r+1)![n+1-(r+1)]!}$$

$$= \frac{(n+1)!}{(r+1)!(n-r)!}$$

$${}^{n+1}C_{r+1} = \frac{(n+1)!}{(r+1)![n+1-(r+1)]!}$$

NOTE: Many errors for ${}^{n+1}C_{r+1} = \frac{(n+1)!}{(r+1)!(n-r)!}$
 Also be clear $\frac{(n+1)!}{(r+1)!(n-r)!} = \frac{(n+1)!}{(r+1)![n+1-(r+1)]!} = {}^{n+1}C_{r+1}$
 do not go straight there
 negative not well dealt with.

(1/2) Correctly writes a combination in factorial notation (any of them)

(1) Correctly makes a common denominator from unrolling technique. (Some 1/2 marks if some working was incorrect)

(1/2) Correctly proves result with justification for the highlighted part of the proof

or some mention of $LHS = \frac{(n+1)!}{(r+1)!(n-r)!}$

Q14 d) continued

! "\$%# '&' () ! ! % * + & '

$$(ii) \quad \binom{n+1}{r+1} = \binom{n}{r} + \binom{n}{r+1}$$

$$\binom{2025}{41} + \binom{2025}{42} + \binom{2026}{43} = \binom{p}{q}$$

$$\binom{2025}{41} + \binom{2025}{42} + \binom{2026}{43}$$

$$= \binom{2025+1}{42} + \binom{2026}{43}$$

$$= \binom{2026}{42} + \binom{2026}{43}$$

$$= \binom{2026+1}{43}$$

$$= \binom{2027}{43}$$

$$= \binom{p}{q}$$

$$\therefore p = 2027$$

$$q = 43$$

Q15.

! "\$%# '&'() ! ! %*+&'

a(i)

Method 1

$$\text{If } \underline{r}_A(t) = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} t \underline{i} + \left(\frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} t - 5t^2 \right) \underline{j}$$

$$\text{then } \underline{v}_A(t) = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} \underline{i} + \left(\frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} - 10t \right) \underline{j}$$

Projectile A reaches its maximum height when its vertical velocity, $\dot{y}_A = 0$

$$\therefore \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} - 10t = 0$$

$$10t = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2}$$

$$t = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{20} \text{ seconds}$$

! for fully correct proof, explaining where equation comes from.

Method 2

Find time of flight of Projectile A by finding when $y_A = 0$, then half.

$$\frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} t - 5t^2 = 0$$

$$t \left(\frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} - 5t \right) = 0$$

Q15

! "\$%# '&'() ! ! %*+&'

a(i) cont'd.

$$5t = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2}$$

$$t = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{10} \quad \text{— time of whole flight}$$

∴ Projectile reaches max height at

$$t = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{10} \div 2$$

$$t = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{20} \text{ seconds.}$$

Method 3

Find maximum of y_A by using the vertex formula $x = \frac{-b}{2a}$.

$$\begin{aligned} y_A &= \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} t - 5t^2 \\ &= -5t^2 + \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} t \end{aligned}$$

$$t = \frac{-b}{2a} = \frac{-\frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2}}{2(-5)} \quad \text{— 1}$$

$$= \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{20} \text{ seconds.}$$

Q15

! "\$%#'&'() ! ! %*+&'

a)(ii)

Method 1 At point P, the y component of each projectile is equal.

$$\text{i.e. } y_A = y_B$$

$$\therefore \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} t - 5t^2 = \frac{V}{2} t - 5t^2$$

$$\therefore \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} t = \frac{V}{2} t$$

$$\therefore V = U\sqrt{2}$$

Method 2 At point P, we know the time is $t = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{20}$.

At point P, the vertical velocity of projectile B is also zero.

$$\text{i.e. } \dot{y}_B = 0$$

$$v_B(t) = -\frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} \hat{j} - \left(\frac{V}{2} - 10t\right) \hat{j}$$

$$\therefore \frac{V}{2} - 10t = 0$$

Q15

! "\$%# '&'() ! ! %*+&'

a) ii) cont'd

$$10t = \frac{v}{2}$$

$$t = \frac{v}{20}$$

$$\therefore t = \frac{v}{20} = \frac{v\sqrt{2}}{20} \quad (\text{from part (i)})$$

$$\therefore v = v\sqrt{2}.$$

Part ii) was fairly well done.

For Method 1, many students made this a lengthy process, by substituting t , rather than just cancelling as shown in solution.

Q 15

! "\$%# '&' (! ! %*+&'

a)(iii) To determine d , we can use the fact that the horizontal position of both projectiles is equal at point P.

i.e. $x_A = x_B$ — 1 for using this

$$\therefore \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} t = d - \frac{U\sqrt{3}}{2} t$$

$$d = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} t + \frac{U\sqrt{3}}{2} t$$

at Point P, $t = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{20}$ and $v = U\sqrt{2}$

So substituting these:

$$d = \frac{U\sqrt{2}}{2} \left(\frac{U\sqrt{2}}{20} \right) + \frac{U\sqrt{2} \times \sqrt{3}}{2} \left(\frac{U\sqrt{2}}{20} \right)$$

$$d = \frac{2U^2}{40} + \frac{U\sqrt{6} \times U\sqrt{2}}{40}$$

$$d = \frac{2U^2 + U^2\sqrt{12}}{40}$$

$$d = \frac{U^2 (2 + 2\sqrt{3})}{40}$$

$$d = \frac{U^2 (1 + \sqrt{3})}{20}$$

1 for anything equivalent.

A number of students thought that projectile A would land where projectile B was projected from, and so used tried to use the range of A.

Q15

! "#\$%#'&'()!!%*+&'

(b) If 3 forces are acting on a object,
and the object is in equilibrium,
then $F_1 + F_2 + F_3 = 0$ ← no movement.

So adding the x-component:

$$-a^2 + 3a + k + 4 - 3a - 2k = 0 \quad (1) \quad - 1 \text{ mark.}$$

and y components:

$$a^3 - 6a - 10a + k - 24 = 0 \quad (2)$$

Unfortunately a number of students thought
the forces were equal to each other.

Simplifying the equations and then eliminating k:

$$(1) \quad -a^2 - k + 4 = 0$$

$$k = 4 - a^2$$

$$(2) \quad a^3 - 16a + k - 24 = 0$$

$$\text{SUB } k = 4 - a^2$$

$$a^3 - 16a + 4 - a^2 - 24 = 0$$

$$a^3 - a^2 - 16a - 20 = 0 \quad - \downarrow$$

(needs to be a
cubic equation)

Unfortunately many students simplified equation (1)
incorrectly.

Q15 b) cont'd

! "\$%# '&'() ! ! %*+&'

To find a , the cubic equation needs to be factorised and solved.

$$a^3 - a^2 - 16a - 20 = 0$$

Use factors of -20 to look for zeroes.

$$F(-2) = 0$$

$$F(5) = 0$$

} calculator can be used.

$\therefore (a+2)(a-5)$ is a factor
 $= a^2 - 3a - 10$

$$\begin{array}{r} a+2 \\ a^2-3a-10 \overline{) a^3-a^2-16a-20} \\ \underline{a^3-3a^2-10a} \\ 2a^2-6a-20 \\ \underline{2a^2-6a-20} \\ 0 \end{array}$$

$\therefore$ Equation factorises to

$$(a+2)^2(a-5) = 0$$

$$\therefore a = -2 \text{ or } 5.$$

} - 1 for confirming 3rd root is multiple, and then answering.

A number of students need to revise factoring polynomials.

Q15 b) cont'd

! "\$%# '&'() ! ! %*+&'

Alternate method to division

$$\text{If } p(a) = a^3 - a^2 - 16a - 20$$

$$p'(a) = 3a^2 - 2a - 16$$

$$= 3a^2 + 6a - 8a - 16$$

$$= 3a(a+2) - 8(a+2)$$

$$= (3a - 8)(a+2)$$

$$\therefore p'(-2) = 0$$

$\therefore (a+2)$ is a root of multiplicity 2.

$$\therefore p(a) = (a+2)^2(a-5)$$

$$\therefore \text{Equation is } (a+2)^2(a-5) = 0$$

$$\therefore a = -2 \text{ or } 5.$$

Q15

! "#\$%# '&'() ! ! %*+&'

c)(i) You need to identify what the diagonals of the rhombus are in terms of $\underline{a}$ and $\underline{b}$. The diagonals must be referred to and linked to these vectors.

$$\begin{array}{l} \vec{OC} = \underline{a} + \underline{b} \quad \text{or} \quad |\vec{OC}| = |\underline{a} + \underline{b}| \\ \vec{AB} = \underline{b} - \underline{a} \quad |\vec{AB}| = |\underline{b} - \underline{a}| \end{array} \quad \left. \vphantom{\begin{array}{l} \vec{OC} = \underline{a} + \underline{b} \\ \vec{AB} = \underline{b} - \underline{a} \end{array}} \right\} \text{1 mark}$$

Given that the area of the rhombus $4u^2$,

$$\frac{1}{2} \times |\vec{OC}| \times |\vec{AB}| = 4 \quad - \frac{1}{2}$$

$$\frac{1}{2} \times |\underline{a} + \underline{b}| \times |\underline{b} - \underline{a}| = 4$$

$$|\underline{a} + \underline{b}| \times |\underline{b} - \underline{a}| = 8 \quad - \frac{1}{2}$$

Squaring both sides:

$$|\underline{a} + \underline{b}|^2 |\underline{b} - \underline{a}|^2 = 64$$

- Many students failed to link $\underline{a} + \underline{b}$ and $\underline{b} - \underline{a}$ to the diagonals
- Many students failed to add the magnitude symbols when appropriate. They need to understand when they are describing a vector versus a magnitude.

Q15

! "\$%# '&'() ! ! %* +&'

c) (ii)

Some students did not recognise that the word "hence" infers they should use the result above.

$$|\underline{a} + \underline{b}|^2 |\underline{b} - \underline{a}|^2 = 64$$

Looking at the first part, and Since $|\underline{u}|^2 = \underline{u} \cdot \underline{u}$

$$\begin{aligned} |\underline{a} + \underline{b}|^2 &= (\underline{a} + \underline{b}) \cdot (\underline{a} + \underline{b}) \\ &= \underline{a} \cdot \underline{a} + \underline{a} \cdot \underline{b} + \underline{b} \cdot \underline{a} + \underline{b} \cdot \underline{b} \\ &= |\underline{a}|^2 + 2\underline{a} \cdot \underline{b} + |\underline{b}|^2 \\ &= 2|\underline{a}|^2 + 2\underline{a} \cdot \underline{b} \end{aligned}$$

Since $|\underline{a}| = |\underline{b}|$ (side lengths of rhombus equal)

$$\text{Similarly: } |\underline{b} - \underline{a}|^2 = 2|\underline{a}|^2 - 2\underline{a} \cdot \underline{b}$$

$$\therefore |\underline{a} + \underline{b}|^2 |\underline{b} - \underline{a}|^2 = 64$$

$$\text{Becomes } (2|\underline{a}|^2 + 2\underline{a} \cdot \underline{b})(2|\underline{a}|^2 - 2\underline{a} \cdot \underline{b}) = 64$$

$$[2|\underline{a}|^2]^2 - [2\underline{a} \cdot \underline{b}]^2 = 64$$

$$4|\underline{a}|^4 - 4(\underline{a} \cdot \underline{b})^2 = 64$$

$$\text{Divide by 4: } |\underline{a}|^4 - (\underline{a} \cdot \underline{b})^2 = 16$$